



Sofrito

COCINA BORICUA



Boricua Weeknights

Ortiz family recipes on your table in 30 minutes, every night — no recipe required.

- The 6-step planning-to-table workflow
- The 30-minute template that makes any dinner
- 50 “no-recipe” dinners, five categories
- Grocery-to-menu matching tool
- Pantry checklist + shopping trip planner

THE WEEKNIGHTS SYSTEM • SOFRITO — COCINA BORICUA

The 6-Step Workflow

Del plan a la mesa, sin estrés

Boricua cooking isn't hard — it's just built on one base and a lot of repetition. Do these six steps once, and dinner answers itself all week.

STEP 1

Master the base

20 MIN, ONCE A MONTH

Batch your sofrito and freeze 28 cubes. This is the engine of the whole system — every single dinner below starts with one cube.

STEP 2

Stock the pantry

20 MIN, ONCE A MONTH

Check the pantry list (page 7) and top up. Rice, beans, sofrito, oil, garlic and onions cover 80% of the 50 dinners.

STEP 3

Plan from the 50

10 MIN, SUNDAY

Pick 3–5 dinners from the 50 list. Write them on the weekly planner — done in minutes because there's no recipe to read.

STEP 4

Match to your fridge

2 MIN

Use the matching tool (page 6): what you already have decides tonight. Leftover rice? You're 20 minutes from mampostiao.

STEP 5

Prep the base

60 MIN, SUNDAY

One pot of arroz blanco, one pot of habichuelas, one tray of seasoned chicken. Pre-cooked bases turn 30-minute dinners into 15.

STEP 6

Cook the template

30 MIN, EVERY NIGHT

Never memorize a recipe again — run the 30-minute template (next page). Sofrito + protein + starch + rest, every time.

The weekly rhythm: Sunday = plan + prep (90 min total). Monday–Friday = cook only (30 min). Saturday = the fun one — mofongo, alcapurrias, or a proper pernil day.

The 30-Minute Template

La plantilla que nunca falla

Every boricua weeknight dinner is this same five-move pattern with different players. Learn the template, and the 50 dinners write themselves.

1 — SOFRITO

The base

1 cube in hot oil **2 min**

2 — PROTEIN

The star

chicken, beef, pork,
fish, beans **5–8 min**

3 — SAUCE

The flavor

tomato, broth,
olives, calabaza **5 min**

4 — STARCH

The comfort

pre-made rice, or
rice into the pot **10–15 min**

5 — REST

The payoff

5 min off heat, then
fluff & plate **5 min**

SWAP ANY PLAYER

- ☐ Protein: chicken, ground beef, pork chops, fish, shrimp, beans
- ☐ Sauce: tomato sauce, broth, sofrito + water, calabaza purée
- ☐ Starch: arroz blanco, gandules rice, leftover rice, tostones
- ☐ Bases pre-made Sunday → dinner in 15 minutes flat

SEASONING SHORTLIST

- ☐ Adobo on every protein — the default
- ☐ Sazón for color and depth in rice and guisos
- ☐ Oregano + bay leaf for stews
- ☐ Alcaparrado whenever you want a pop

Pro tip: if the protein is pre-seasoned (Step 5), skip the adobo — you're already at 20 minutes. This template is the "no-recipe" in the 50 no-recipe dinners.

The 50 No-Recipe Dinners

Part 1 — the first 25

No measuring. No cards. Each line is a pattern your sofrito cube already knows how to run.

A • ARROZ & HABICHUELAS (1–10)

- | | |
|--|--|
| 1 Arroz con Pollo — chicken, sofrito, rice, broth | 2 Arroz con Gandules — gandules, sofrito, rice |
| 3 Arroz con Salchichas — sausages, tomato, rice | 4 Arroz Blanco + Habichuelas — the daily plate |
| 5 Mampostiao — leftover rice + beans, fried crisp | 6 Mampostiao + Pollo Guisado — double leftovers, double win |
| 7 Arroz con Bacalao — salt cod, sofrito, rice | 8 Arroz con Maíz Dulce — sweet corn folded in |
| 9 Arroz con Frijoles Negros — island-style black beans | 10 Arroz con Cilantro y Ajo — bright green side-star as a main |

B • GUISOS & ONE-POTS (11–20)

- | | |
|---|--|
| 11 Pollo Guisado — stewed chicken, potato, calabaza | 12 Carne Guisada — stewed beef, deep color |
| 13 Habichuelas con Papa — beans + potatoes, thicker sauce | 14 Bacalao Guisado — salt cod, peppers, tomato |
| 15 Sancocho de Res — roots + corn, a Sunday-long one | 16 Picadillo — ground beef, olives, raisins |
| 17 Picadillo con Huevo Frito — the crowning fried egg | 18 Pollo en Salsa — saucy chicken over rice |
| 19 Costillas Guisadas — stewed ribs, fall-apart | 20 Chuletas Guisadas — pork chops in guiso |

C • SKILLET, GRILL & FRITURA MAINS (21–25)

- | | |
|---|--|
| 21 Bistec Encebollado — steak + onions, plate licking | 22 Chuletas a la Plancha + Maduros — grilled chops, sweet plantain |
| 23 Pollo al Horno + Amarillos — baked adobo chicken | 24 Pollo Frito + Tostones — the kiosk combo at home |
| 25 Mofongo con Sopa de Pollo — plantain dome + broth | |

Part 1 of 2. Twenty-five more in part 2 — seafood, meatless, eggs, and the fun ones.

The 50 No-Recipe Dinners

Part 2 — the final 25

C • SKILLET, GRILL & FRITURA MAINS (26–30)

26 Mofongo Relleno de Camarones — stuffed, saucy shrimp

28 Sorullos con Queso — cornmeal sticks, cheese core

30 Alcapurrias Night — batch-fry a big platter

27 Tostones con Guiso — crisp disks + beef stew

29 Bacalaitos con Aguacate — cod fritters + creamy avocado

D • EGGS, QUICK & BREAKFAST-FOR-DINNER (31–40)

31 Huevos Revueltos + Salchichas + Amarillos — the 15-minute plate

33 Huevos Guisados con Arroz — eggs in guiso over rice

35 Arepas de Maíz con Queso — corn cakes, melty center

37 Quesadilla Boricua — pernil or pollo + maduros inside

39 Arroz Frito Boricua — leftover rice, egg, peas, sofrito

32 Tortilla de Papa y Cebolla — the Spanish classic, boricua-style

34 Revuelto de Bacalao — salt cod + eggs scramble

36 Sándwich de Pernil — leftover roast + mayo-ketchup

38 Pizza de Tostones — plantain rounds, sauce, cheese

40 Empanadillas — frozen dough + any guiso filling

E • SEAFOOD & MEATLESS (41–50)

41 Camarones al Ajillo — garlic shrimp, fast

43 Pescado Guisado — white fish, tomato, olives

45 Sopa de Mariscos — seafood stew, island warmth

47 Arroz con Gandules Vegetariano — skip the pork, keep the flavor

49 Mofongo Vegano + Guiso de Habichuelas — no chicharrón, all soul

42 Camarones Guisados — shrimp in guiso + rice

44 Pescado Frito + Tostones — the beach-plate dinner

46 Habichuelas con Calabaza — vegan guiso, creamy depth

48 Ensalada de Garbanzos — chickpeas, olive oil, lime

50 Arroz con Coco — sweet-salty island rice, alone it wins

That's the fifty. Five categories, ten each. You only ever need three a week — the other forty-seven are insurance against a boring Monday.

Grocery-to-Menu Matching Tool

Qué tienes en la nevera → qué cenas

The reverse way to plan: look at what you actually have, not what a recipe demands. Tonight's dinner is one row away.

In your fridge / pantry	Tonight's dinner
Chicken + rice + sofrito	Arroz con Pollo (1)
Ground beef + sofrito + olives	Picadillo (16) — or stuffed empanadillas (40)
Pork chops + sofrito	Chuletas Guisadas (20)
White fish or shrimp + sofrito	Pescado/Camarones Guisados (42–43)
Shrimp + garlic + butter	Camarones al Ajillo (41)
Pink beans + calabaza	Habichuelas con Calabaza (46)
Leftover arroz blanco + beans	Mampostiao (5)
Leftover rice + eggs + peas	Arroz Frito Boricua (39)
Green plantains + broth	Mofongo con Sopa de Pollo (25)
Ripe plantains + eggs + salchichas	Huevos + Amarillos (31)
Salt cod + tomato + peppers	Bacalao Guisado (14)
Salt cod + flour + cornmeal	Bacalaitos (29)
Frozen empanada dough + any guiso	Empanadillas (40)
Black beans + rice	Arroz con Frijoles Negros (9)
Cornmeal + cheese	Sorullos (28)
Leftover pernil	Sándwich de Pernil (36) — celebrate

How to use it: scan the left column before you shop. Whatever you land on three times = your three dinners this week. The tool kills the “what’s for dinner?” panic because it starts from the truth of your fridge.

Pantry Staple Checklist

Lo que siempre tienes que tener

Stock this once and 80% of the 50 dinners are always an option. Print it, magnet it to the fridge, cross things off as you run low.

BASES & SEASONINGS

- ☐ Sofrito cubes (28 in the freezer)
- ☐ Sazón with annatto
- ☐ Adobo
- ☐ Dried oregano & bay leaves
- ☐ Ground cumin & coriander
- ☐ Black pepper & salt
- ☐ Garlic (always two heads)

RICE & BEANS

- ☐ Medium-grain rice (5 lb)
- ☐ Canned gandules (pigeon peas)
- ☐ Pink beans, canned or dried
- ☐ Black beans
- ☐ Chickpeas (garbanzos)

CANS & JARS

- ☐ Tomato sauce
- ☐ Tomato paste
- ☐ Diced tomatoes
- ☐ Alcaparrado (olives + capers)
- ☐ Chicken & beef broth
- ☐ Olive oil & canola oil
- ☐ Distilled vinegar
- ☐ Mayonnaise & ketchup (the classic sauce)

FRESH (WEEKLY)

- ☐ Yellow onions
- ☐ Green & red bell peppers
- ☐ Fresh cilantro / culantro
- ☐ Green plantains
- ☐ Ripe plantains
- ☐ Calabaza (tropical pumpkin)
- ☐ Potatoes
- ☐ Limes & avocados

FROZEN & FRIDGE

- ☐ Chicken thighs & breasts
- ☐ Ground beef & pork chops
- ☐ Shrimp (quick thaw)
- ☐ Vienna sausages / smoked links
- ☐ Eggs (dozen)
- ☐ Frozen empanada dough
- ☐ Butter & queso blanco

WEEKEND & HOLIDAYS

- ☐ Pork shoulder (pernil)
- ☐ Salt cod (bacalao)
- ☐ Cornmeal
- ☐ All-purpose flour
- ☐ Coconut milk
- ☐ Condensed & evaporated milk
- ☐ White rum (coquito season)

Shopping Trip Planner

Una sola vuelta, toda la semana

One trip a week, never a sad empty fridge on a Tuesday. Fill this in Sunday, shop Monday, cook all week.

1 — MENU PICKS (FROM THE 50)

- ☐ Monday: _____
- ☐ Tuesday: _____
- ☐ Wednesday: _____
- ☐ Thursday: _____
- ☐ Friday: _____
- ☐ Saturday (the fun one): _____

2 — OUT OF PANTRY STOCK?

3 — PRODUCE THIS WEEK

4 — PROTEIN

5 — FROZEN & FRIDGE

6 — EVERYTHING ELSE

Copy the whole system to your fridge: print the pantry checklist (page 7), the matching tool (page 6), and this planner — three pages, zero decision fatigue all month.

THE SYSTEM

You've got fifty dinners in your back pocket.

Plan once on Sunday, prep for an hour, cook 30 minutes a night — no recipes, no panic, no cereal for dinner.

The Full Table — cookbook + weeknights + printables	\$97
+ La Mesa Boricua — full 30-recipe cookbook	\$47
+ The Kitchen Bundle — printables pack	\$67
Mofongo & More — the 6-week course	\$197

— ¡Pa'lante! Plan it, cook it, enjoy it. Con amor, de la cocina Ortiz.